

ASUS EN8800GT 1GB

An 8800GT With The Ultimate Top-up Plan!

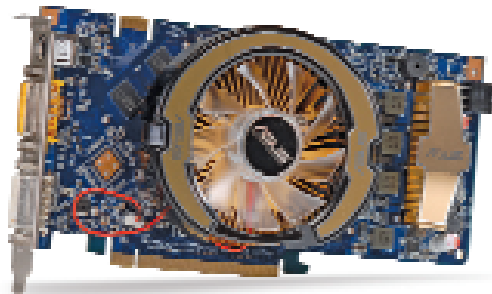
The ASUS 8800GT is like any other 8800GT, except this one has been filled to the brim with a whopping 1 GB of memory. This isn't the only 1GB card to come to our labs—the Palit 8500GT was another one, but didn't quite outperform the other 8500GT-based cards. Could it be a similar fate for this card?

First things first—the 1GB card doesn't come with the standard NVIDIA cooler; it's been replaced by a much more robust and chunky cooler and an equally good fan. There's no cooling for the memory, though. Overall, it's very quiet and runs just fine

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Bundle	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

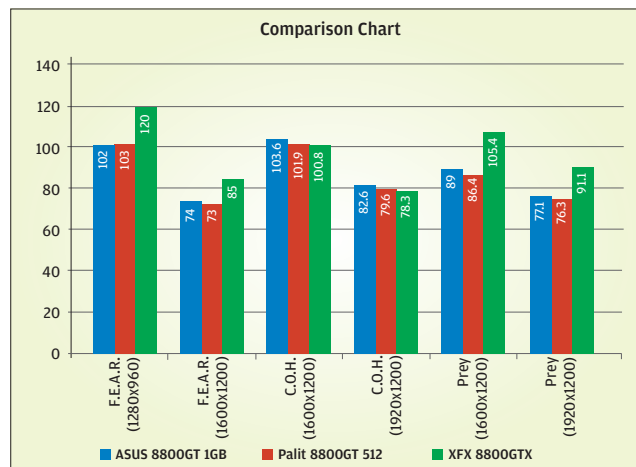
with temperatures hovering around the 50° C mark.

Even with FSAA turned up to 4x and Antistrophic filtering to 8x, we were able to very respectable frame rates in *Company of Heroes*, *F.E.A.R.* and *Doom 3*, but the frame rate was only fractionally more than the standard 512 MB 8800GTs.



The ASUS 8800GT 1GB comes with no bundled games, and at a price of Rs 18,900. It's evident that

there are no clear benefits from using the much large frame buffer. If you have set a higher budget for a card, then this 8800GT 1GB could be worth it—if you can get it for around Rs 15,000 in the market. Anything over that, and you're better off saving for a 512 MB 8800GTs.



Specifications

GeForce 8800GT, 1GB DDR3, PCI-E 1 and 2 supported, DirectX 10 complaint, Shader Model 4.0 supported

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Price: Rs 18,900

AMD DTX form factor

The Environment's New Green Buddy

Not everyone wants to play games, and the performance you can get out of today's PC is a lot more than required for basic office applications and movie playback, for example. AMD believes it's time for cheap and quiet low-power PCs to make their mark and they've been pushing hard for it.

The DTX system uses a dual-core Athlon X2 BE-2350. The machine that we tested came with 1 GB of RAM and an onboard graphics solution. The entire PC was housed in a compact case with all the bells and whistles. No PS2 ports on this machine, so you will have to use a USB keyboard and mouse.

To keep it quiet, the CPU fan has been surrounded by a thick foam packing. The size of the motherboard itself is a tad smaller than the standard Micro-ATX. Even the hard drive is mounted vertically next to



the memory card reader and optical disc drives. Things do tend to get hot because of the cramped layout, though.

In encoding tests and general synthetic tests on SiSoft Sandra, results were average. The advantage of using a dual-core processor was obvious as well—it ate through the 1080p HD clips that we threw at it. This setup isn't cut out as a gaming PC at all—*Doom 3* struggling at just 20fps at 800 x 600 and medium settings. The performance in *Far Cry* was a little better at 40fps at minimum settings, but gaming really isn't going to be its forte.

As power efficient, quiet and cheap machine, it has everything going for it especially when there's support from a large number of hardware



manufacturers. There's also a growing demand and trend in compact form factors as people start moving their PCs into their living rooms. If AMD is to market this product as an entry level PC or an HTPC, it has everything necessary to be a possible hit if they keep the price around the Rs 10,000 mark.